CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

EVENT PLANNER IN THE AI ERA

One date, fifty vendors, two hundred guests and zero tolerance for 'oops' — planners are paid for the disaster that never happens.

★ TL;DR — Around $75K median for planners who can build a vendor network and portfolio in 1–6 months, no license required. The catch: weekends, crises and clients who think 'simple' means 'cheap'. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

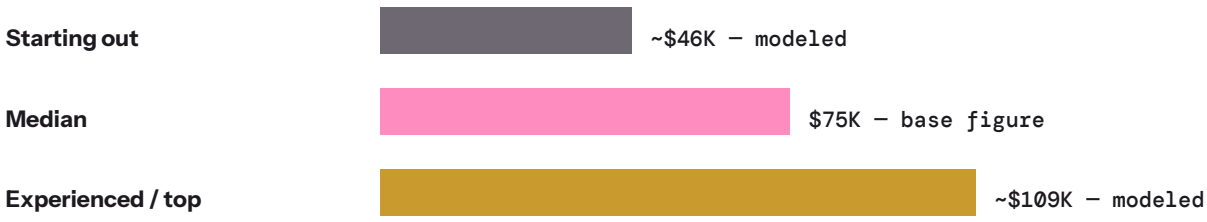
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Why it works: companies and families keep outsourcing the stress of gatherings that matter.
- Where it bites: you carry everyone's emergencies in your phone, on the day, in real time.
- The AI angle: AI drafts timelines and chases RSVPs; it cannot taste the cake, calm the client or rebuild a floor plan in the rain.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Event Planner is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A EVENT PLANNER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Design events around a budget: venue, catering, decor, entertainment, flow
- ✓ Book and manage vendors, contracts, deposits and timelines
- ✓ Run the day like a stage manager: cues, fixes, invisible problems
- ✓ Close out: breakdown, invoices, photos, and the review that books the next one

Think: a film producer whose premiere happens once, live, with no editing room.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Planning software now drafts timelines, seating charts, vendor emails and budget trackers. Client intake and follow-up run on automation.	Taste, vendor leverage and crisis calm are the human premium: knowing which florist saves a rainy Saturday and how to move two hundred people without them noticing a problem.

⚠ **Your reputation is one bad event from a crater. Contracts, deposits and backup plans are the unglamorous core of the profession.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ No two projects alike; constant variety ✓ You are in the room for people's best days ✓ Strong planners build very portable businesses	✗ Evenings and weekends are the product ✗ Vendor no-shows become your emergency ✗ Emotionally invested clients, hourly

Good fit? You are organized to the minute, charming under pressure, and secretly love a run-sheet.
Bad fit? You wilt in chaos, avoid hard phone calls, or think planning means picking colors.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — ASSIST AT AN EVENTS COMPANY	DOOR B — NICHE SOLO EVENTS
Join a planning firm, venue or catering company in coordination roles. You learn vendor management and day-of production on someone else's reputation — the fastest credibility in the business.	Start with one event type — corporate mixers, birthdays, pop-ups, nonprofit galas — and own it locally. A narrow portfolio and vendor list beat a vague 'I plan everything' from day one.

Smart move: Build a vendor bench with real relationships: your florist, DJ and rental contact answering your call first is a competitive advantage clients can feel.
Where you land after: Your own planning studio with a signature event type, or production lead for venues and brands.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN EVENT	PICK YOUR	BUILD THE	FIRST EVENTS,	PACKAGE YOUR	BOOK THROUGH

STEP 1 — Learn event anatomy

FREE · WEEKS 1-2

- Budgets, timelines, vendor categories and contracts
- Volunteer or assist at two real events — watch everything

STEP 2 — Pick your event niche

WEEK 2-3

- One event type with repeat buyers nearby
- Study its standard budgets and expectations

STEP 3 — Build the vendor bench

MONTHS 1-2

- Venues, caterers, florists, rentals, entertainment — met in person
- A planner is only as good as this phone list

STEP 4 — First events, assisted

PAID · MONTHS 1-3

- Coordinate under an experienced planner or venue
- Run your own small events where stakes are survivable

STEP 5 — Package your service

MONTHS 3-4

- Full planning, partial and day-of coordination tiers
- Contracts and deposits — always, in writing

STEP 6 — Book through proof

MONTHS 4-6

- Photograph every event; collect vendor and client reviews
- Referrals between vendors quietly fill calendars

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

 Today: break down an event you attended into its hidden vendor list and timeline.

□ Days 1–30: assist at real events; start meeting vendors in your niche.

□ Days 31–60: coordinate small events; build your run-sheet and contract templates.

□ Days 61–90: launch packaged services and book your first solo clients.

□ Day 90: a working planner with a bench and proof — bigger rooms follow.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest "probably NOT you". → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ CALM IS THE PRODUCT. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.